

Assess bilateral optic disc swelling

Papilloedema means optic disc swelling from raised intracranial pressure.



Papilloedema: bilateral swollen optic discs. The source labels A as the right eye and B as the left eye.

Clinical meaning

Early papilloedema can preserve acuity and pupil responses. Ask about morning headache, pulsatile tinnitus and brief obscurations. Check BP and obtain brain imaging; exclude a mass before an appropriate LP. Enlarged blind spots or a false localising sixth nerve palsy may accompany raised ICP. Not all swollen discs are papilloedema.

Field side refers to visual space

A right retrochiasmal lesion affects the left visual field of both eyes.

Left homonymous field loss

Patient view; shaded regions represent impaired vision



Original schematic: each eye loses left visual space, as expected with a right retrochiasmal lesion.

Clinical meaning

Monocular loss suggests the eye or optic nerve anterior to the chiasm. Bitemporal loss localises to the chiasm, including compression by a pituitary mass. Homonymous loss involves the opposite retrochiasmal pathway; more congruous patterns usually indicate a more posterior lesion. Temporal radiation injury can produce contralateral upper-quadrant loss. MRI characterises intracranial visual pathway lesions.